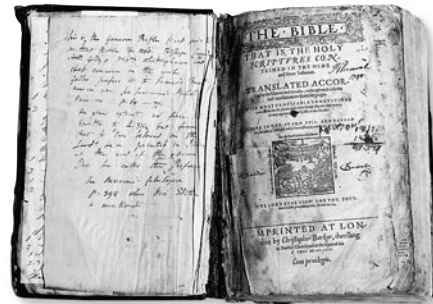


Religious conflict

THE 16TH CENTURY was a time of bitter religious divisions. All English people were Christian, but there were two rival versions of the faith: Catholicism and Protestantism. In 1534, Henry VIII broke with the Catholic Church and declared himself head of an Anglican, or English, Church. Under his son Edward VI (1547–53), the Anglican Church became Protestant. There was a swing back to Catholicism under Mary (1553–58), but Elizabeth (1588–1603) restored Protestantism, fining anyone who refused to worship in an Anglican church. The Protestants were split into Anglicans and Puritans, people who thought the break with Catholics had not gone far enough.



Mary, crowned Queen of Heaven, holds the baby Jesus



AN ENGLISH BIBLE

The Bible that Shakespeare knew is known as the Geneva Bible. Catholics used a Latin Bible, but Protestants thought that everyone should be able to read the book in their own language. When Mary came to the throne, a group of Protestants fled to Geneva, where they wrote this English translation.

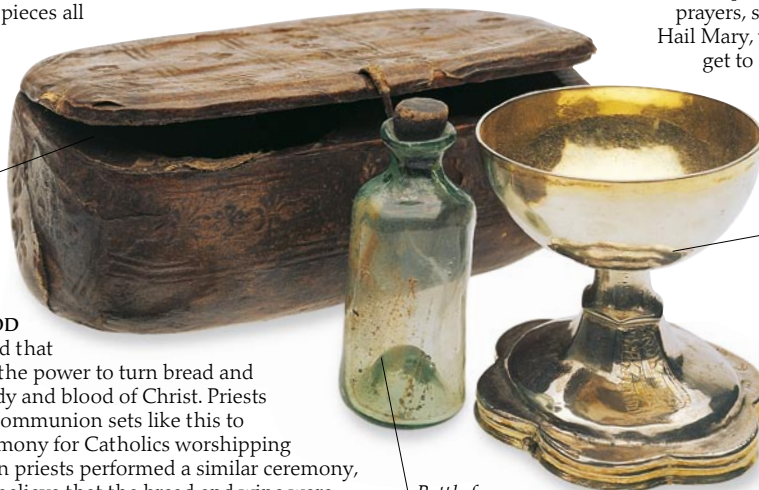
QUEEN OF HEAVEN

Catholics prayed in front of statues of saints, such as Mary the mother of Christ, whom they called the Queen of Heaven. Protestants said that there were no special saints in heaven, and they condemned religious statues as idols. Under the Protestant king, Edward VI, statues like this one were smashed to pieces all over England.

Leather carrying case

BODY AND BLOOD

Catholics believed that their priests had the power to turn bread and wine into the body and blood of Christ. Priests carried portable communion sets like this to perform the ceremony for Catholics worshipping in secret. Anglican priests performed a similar ceremony, but they did not believe that the bread and wine were really changed into Christ's body and blood.



Bottle for carrying wine

Chalice for giving wine at communion

Plate for communion wafers



Christ depicted on the cross

